birth in 1949 and was only recognized by the USA and admitted to the permanent seat in the United Nations Security Council in 1971 and replaced Nationalist China (Taiwan).

Sovereignty

The most important element of statehood is, sovereignty. The term ‘state’ was derived from the Latin ‘status’ which means the ‘position’or ‘standing’ of a ruler. The position of the state is supreme. Sovereignty is the supremacy of the state. The state is supreme in internal as well as external matters. As Hedley Bull (The Anarchical Society, 1977) observes, sovereignty includes “internal sovereignty, which means supremacy over all other authorities within that territory and population” and “external sovereignty, by which is meant not supremacy but independence of outside authorities”.[6] This implies then that the state has supreme power to govern its land and resources and population within its territory as well as in external relation it has no restrictions on its authority, except those, which it has on its own accepted.

In international relations, sovereignty is accepted as a fact and government as representatives of their states, no matter where the jurists or political scientists locate the seat of the ultimate sovereign power. Sovereignty should be seen as a special theoretical relationship between each state and all other states. Though all states on the face of this Earth is considered sovereign and equal, this equality is *legal* and *not factual*. There is a simultaneous presence of states of varied dimensions. Some are considered as major powers, others as middle range powers, yet some others as small and weak. Here, the interplay between sovereignty becomes crucial. As each state tries to pursue its national interests, each of them has to accommodate, make compromises and adjustments, which limits their absolute sovereignty. International law and international regimes also impose restrictions on the behaviour of the state. Clyde Eagleton (1945) took a realistic view of the problem of inter-relationship between international law and sovereignty of states. He said, “sovereignty cannot be an absolute term. It is just as foolish to say that sovereignty must be surrendered or eliminated as